

Gemini product field guide

A clean, practical handbook for chats, files, Deep Research, Canvas, Gems, Connected Apps, mobile use, and responsible work.

COURSE PROMISE

You do not need to be an AI expert. Learn one useful product habit at a time, verify important work, and keep company information inside approved boundaries.

Core track

12 hours / 9 modules / web and mobile / workplace scenarios / guided practice / no coding required

Edition

Version 1.0 - Gemini product field guide. Official Google Help and Workspace guidance reviewed 12 July 2026. Availability varies by account, region, plan, device, and administrator settings.

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00 / Welcome to Gemini

In plain English

Meet the Gemini product, learn what it is good at, and set expectations before your first workplace chat.

New words you will meet: chat, prompt, response, source

This handbook is about the **Gemini product**: the web and mobile experience where you chat with Gemini, attach material, use specialist tools, and connect supported Google services. It is not an API or programming course.

Gemini can help you think, draft, summarize, learn, research, and organize work. It can also misunderstand instructions, miss context, or create an incorrect answer that sounds polished. The productive habit is to use Gemini as a collaborator while keeping human judgment in charge.

The three-step habit

- **Ask clearly.** Give a job, context, constraints, and desired format.
- **Work together.** Read the response and continue the conversation.
- **Verify before use.** Check important claims, numbers, names, links, and decisions.

A draft is not a decision

Gemini can produce a useful first version quickly. You remain responsible for what you send, publish, submit, approve, or act on.

Product availability changes

The buttons and features you see depend on your personal or work account, age, country, language, device, Google AI plan, staged rollout, and administrator settings. If a feature in this handbook is missing, check the official Help Center and ask your Workspace administrator.

A safe first exercise

Ask Gemini to explain a familiar topic at three levels: for a ten-year-old, for a new teammate, and for a specialist. Compare what changes. This demonstrates that audience and context matter without sharing private information.

Your workplace boundary

Before using Gemini for work, find your company's approved-use policy. Write down which account to use, which data classes are allowed, and who to contact when you are unsure.

01 / Ask better questions

In plain English

Give Gemini a clear job, useful context, a format, and a definition of success.

New words you will meet: context, constraint, example, follow-up

You do not need magic prompt words. You need enough information for the task to be understood.

The CRAFT prompt pattern

- **Context:** what situation should Gemini understand?
- **Role or task:** what job should it perform?
- **Audience:** who is the result for?
- **Format:** how should the answer be organized?
- **Tests:** what must a good answer include or avoid?

STRUCTURE

Context: A new teammate joins our support team next Monday.
Task: Draft a first-day checklist.
Audience: Someone new to the company and the product.
Format: A table with time, activity, owner, and purpose.
Tests: Keep it under eight rows. Mark missing owners as "TBD".

Continue instead of restarting

The first answer is a starting point. Useful follow-ups include:

- "Make the language simpler without removing details."
- "Which assumptions did you make?"
- "Give me three alternatives and explain the trade-offs."
- "What important question have I not answered?"
- "Turn this into a checklist I can verify."

Separate source material from instructions

When pasting approved text, label it clearly. Ask Gemini to use only that material and to mark missing information as missing.

STRUCTURE

Use only the material between <notes> tags.
Do not invent dates, owners, or decisions.

```
<notes>
[approved meeting notes go here]
</notes>
```

Return decisions, actions, owners, and open questions.

This improves clarity, but it is not a security control. Do not paste prohibited data.

Pick the right output

Ask for a table when comparing items, a checklist for repeatable work, an outline before a long draft, questions when context is missing, or a short executive summary when the reader has little time.

Do not hide uncertainty

Avoid prompts that demand certainty. Ask Gemini to identify assumptions, missing evidence, and areas that need verification.

02 / Work with files and media

In plain English

Upload approved documents, spreadsheets, images, audio, or video and ask focused questions about the material.

New words you will meet: upload, attachment, analysis, evidence

Gemini Apps can analyze supported documents, spreadsheets, NotebookLM notebooks, images, audio, video, and other files. Availability and limits vary.

Before uploading

- Confirm your account is approved for the material.
- Remove information that is irrelevant to the task.
- Check file permissions, ownership, and retention expectations.
- Use a clean filename and explain what the file contains.
- Decide what evidence you need from the response.

Ask focused questions

“Summarize this file” may produce something useful, but focused requests are easier to verify:

- “List the three decisions and quote the sentence supporting each one.”
- “Compare Q1 and Q2 values in a table; do not calculate missing cells.”
- “Find contradictory deadlines and identify their pages.”
- “Describe only what is visibly present in the image.”
- “Create five questions a reviewer should ask about this proposal.”

Spreadsheet work

Ask Gemini to explain patterns, propose formulas, flag outliers, or create a chart plan. Verify calculations against the original sheet. Confirm column meaning, units, date ranges, missing values, and whether totals include hidden or filtered rows.

Documents and slides

Use Gemini to create an outline, extract claims, compare versions, identify gaps, or rewrite for a specific audience. Keep the original open beside the answer when accuracy matters.

Images, audio, and video

Media interpretation can be incomplete. Ask for timestamps, visible evidence, or uncertainty where available. Do not use Gemini as the sole authority for identity, medical interpretation, legal evidence, workplace safety certification, or other consequential judgments.

Missing-information test

Upload an approved synthetic brief that intentionally omits a deadline. Ask for owner, goal, deadline, risk, and next step. The useful answer says the deadline is not stated.

03 / Research, Canvas, and learning tools

In plain English

Use specialist product modes for deeper research, editable work, study material, and audio overviews.

New words you will meet: Deep Research, Canvas, quiz, Audio Overview

Gemini includes specialist experiences for work that needs more than a quick chat.

Deep Research

Deep Research can develop a research plan, explore sources, and create a longer report. You can often add files to the task. Use it when a question needs several sources and a traceable synthesis, not when you need a one-sentence answer.

A strong research request states the question, audience, date range, geography, acceptable sources, exclusions, desired depth, and decision the report will support.

Review the proposed plan before the research runs. Afterward, open the cited sources and check whether each important claim is supported, current, and relevant. A citation can exist without proving the nearby sentence.

Canvas

Canvas is an editable workspace for developing documents, code, simple apps, and other artifacts. You can ask Gemini to create a specific format, edit the result directly, select a section, and request a targeted revision.

Use Canvas when the work will go through several versions. A productive loop is:

- Ask for an outline.
- Correct the structure yourself.
- Expand one section at a time.
- Select weak passages and request specific changes.
- Perform a final human edit outside the chat mindset.

Learning tools

Depending on availability, Gemini can create quizzes, flashcards, study guides, and other learning material. Ask it to reveal answers after you attempt the question, explain why distractors are wrong, and adapt the next question to your mistake.

Audio Overviews

Gemini can create Audio Overviews from supported uploaded material. Google notes that generation may take several minutes. Use an overview for orientation, then return to the source for important detail. Audio fluency does not make the content automatically accurate.

Match the mode to the job

Chat is for quick iteration. Deep Research is for multi-source investigation. Canvas is for an editable artifact. Learning tools are for active recall. The mode should follow the outcome you need.

04 / Gems and repeatable workflows

In plain English

Turn a repeated task into a reusable custom helper with stable instructions.

New words you will meet: Gem, instruction, workflow, sharing

A **Gem** is a reusable, customized Gemini helper. It can carry instructions for a repeated task so teammates do not rebuild the prompt every time.

Good Gem candidates

- Convert approved notes into a standard project update.
- Review a draft against a public style checklist.
- Coach a learner through a concept without giving the answer immediately.
- Turn a feature description into test-question drafts.
- Prepare a meeting agenda from a fixed template.

Avoid creating a Gem that pretends to authorize spending, approve policy, make personnel decisions, or access information a user should not see.

Write maintainable Gem instructions

Describe purpose, audience, allowed inputs, required steps, output format, missing-information behavior, prohibited behavior, and a few representative examples.

STRUCTURE

Purpose: Turn approved project notes into a weekly update.
Required sections: Goal, Progress, Risks, Decisions, Next actions.
Rules:
- Use only the supplied notes.
- Never invent an owner or deadline.
- Write "Not stated" when information is missing.
- Ask one follow-up question if the goal is unclear.

Test before sharing

Use ordinary input, incomplete input, conflicting input, very long input, and an instruction hidden inside the material. Confirm the Gem refuses to invent data and does not follow untrusted text that conflicts with its purpose.

When sharing is available, explain the Gem's scope and owner. Review it when policy, templates, or product behavior changes.

05 / Connected Apps and Google Workspace

In plain English

Let Gemini work with supported Google services while staying aware of permissions and account controls.

New words you will meet: Connected App, Workspace, permission, admin

Connected Apps let Gemini work with supported Google and third-party services. Examples and availability depend on account, platform, settings, and administrator controls.

Permission is part of the prompt

Before asking Gemini to find, summarize, create, or send something through a connected service, consider:

- Which account is active?
- Which app is connected?
- What information can that account access?
- Is Gemini reading, drafting, or taking an action?
- Will the user review before anything is sent or changed?

Google Workspace scenarios

With organizational support, Gemini may help find information, summarize material, prepare communications, or work across Workspace products. Admins can restrict Gemini access and features. Your visible controls may therefore differ from a personal account.

Useful requests are explicit about location and time:

- "Find emails from the launch group from the past seven days and list unresolved questions."
- "Summarize this Drive document for a new engineer; preserve linked source titles."
- "Draft a calendar description, but do not create the event yet."

Review actions before they happen

For messages, calendar events, calls, home devices, or other actions, verify recipient, account, date, timezone, content, and consequences. Use a draft-first habit whenever the action affects another person or system.

Connected does not mean unlimited

A connected app does not remove workplace access rules. Do not ask Gemini to locate, combine, or expose information you are not permitted to use for the task.

06 / Mobile, Gemini Live, and everyday assistance

In plain English

Use voice, camera, screen context, and mobile actions without forgetting privacy and confirmation.

New words you will meet: Gemini Live, camera, voice, device action

The Gemini mobile app supports text, voice, images, and camera-based questions. Depending on device and settings, it may also act as a mobile assistant and work with connected apps.

Gemini Live

Gemini Live supports a more natural spoken conversation. It is useful for brainstorming, rehearsing, exploring a topic, or thinking while moving. Speak the goal and ask Gemini to pause, challenge an assumption, summarize, or switch direction.

Avoid discussing confidential information where other people or devices can hear. Review any important names, dates, or numbers in text afterward.

Camera and screen context

Camera input can help identify visible objects, translate text, explain a diagram, or discuss surroundings. Screen context can make a question easier to ask. Before sharing, look for notifications, account details, faces, addresses, customer information, or unrelated confidential content.

Device actions

If Gemini can call, message, schedule, navigate, or control a device, keep confirmation enabled for consequential actions. Voice recognition and contact matching can be wrong. Say full names and review the target.

Personal and work accounts

Check which account is active before attaching a file or using Connected Apps. Do not assume a mobile device automatically applies your company's approved settings to a personal account.

07 / Privacy, verification, and safe workplace use

In plain English

Understand activity controls, verify important answers, and keep sensitive work inside approved boundaries.

New words you will meet: activity, temporary chat, verification, feedback

Privacy behavior depends on account type and settings. Read the current Gemini Apps Privacy Hub and your organization's policy rather than relying on assumptions.

Activity and temporary chats

Personal accounts may offer Gemini Apps Activity controls and temporary chats. Google states that temporary chats and chats created while Keep Activity is off can still be retained with the account for up to 72 hours for response context and protection purposes. Temporary chat is not a license to share prohibited data.

Google's help documentation says temporary chats are not available in every surface or for work and school accounts. Workspace retention and controls may be managed by administrators.

A verification ladder

- **Low stakes:** inspect whether the answer is useful and reasonable.
- **Factual work:** open sources and verify names, numbers, dates, and quotes.
- **Company decisions:** compare with the authoritative internal system and ask the owner.
- **High impact:** use qualified professional review and approved processes.

The “related sources” or double-check features can help, but source presence is not proof. Check whether the exact claim is supported.

Watch for confident mistakes

Common warning signs include a source that cannot be opened, a quote missing from the document, a number without a calculation trail, a policy stated without a date, or an answer that ignores ambiguity in the question.

Report and improve

Use product feedback controls for harmful, incorrect, or broken behavior. For workplace incidents, follow internal reporting rules. Do not paste additional sensitive material into feedback unless the process explicitly permits it.

Minimum necessary information

Give Gemini only the information needed for the task. Less unnecessary data means less privacy risk, less distraction, and often a clearer answer.

08 / Team playbook and practical exercises

In plain English

Practice realistic tasks and agree on shared rules for responsible, useful adoption.

New words you will meet: playbook, review, exercise, adoption

Good adoption comes from shared habits, examples, and review—not from asking everyone to “use AI more.”

Suggested team rules

- Use the approved account and product surface.
- Follow the organization's data-classification policy.
- Treat output as a draft until verified.
- Keep a human responsible for every external action.
- Cite sources for important factual work.
- Do not use Gemini as the sole decision maker for high-impact matters.
- Share useful prompt patterns and known failure cases.
- Revisit guidance as features and policies change.

Exercise 1: Rewrite without losing meaning

Give Gemini a synthetic technical update. Ask for versions for an executive, a new teammate, and a customer. Highlight any fact that changed between versions.

Exercise 2: File analysis

Upload an approved sample document. Ask for claims, supporting passages, missing information, and review questions. Confirm every passage in the original.

Exercise 3: Deep Research

Choose a public, non-sensitive question. Define acceptable sources and a date range. Review the research plan, then audit three important citations in the report.

Exercise 4: Build a Gem

Create a Gem for a repeated low-risk team task. Test normal, incomplete, conflicting, and maliciously worded input. Document its owner and limitations.

Exercise 5: Connected action

Ask Gemini to draft—but not send—a calendar event or message. Review account, recipient, date, timezone, content, and attachments before taking the real action.

Course completion demonstration

Each learner should show one useful result, one detected mistake, one verification step, one privacy decision, and one reusable prompt or Gem. Finding a failure is evidence of responsible skill, not a failed demo.

Appendix / Quick reference and official help

In plain English

Use these prompt recipes, checklists, and official links when you need a fast reminder.

New words you will meet: recipe, checklist, Help Center

Fast prompt recipes

Summarize: “Summarize for [audience]. Use only [source]. Include [sections]. Mark missing facts as not stated.”

Compare: “Compare [items] using [criteria]. Return a table. Separate facts from recommendations.”

Critique: “Review this draft against [checklist]. Identify the issue, explain its impact, and suggest a revision. Do not rewrite unaffected sections.”

Research: “Investigate [question] for [decision]. Prefer [sources], cover [dates/region], note disagreements, and cite every important factual claim.”

Learn: “Teach me [topic] at beginner level. Ask one question at a time, wait for my answer, and explain mistakes before continuing.”

Before using an answer

- Did Gemini understand the task and audience?
- Does the response use the correct source material?
- Are names, dates, numbers, and links verified?
- Are assumptions and missing information visible?
- Is the language appropriate and inclusive?
- Is a qualified human required?
- Am I comfortable taking responsibility for this result?

Primary official sources

- [Gemini Apps Help Center](#)
- [Use Gemini Apps](#)
- [Gemini Apps Privacy Hub](#)
- [Upload and analyze files](#)

- [Use Deep Research](#)
- [Create documents and apps with Canvas](#)
- [Generate Audio Overviews](#)
- [Use and manage Connected Apps](#)
- [Get started with the mobile app](#)
- [Find and manage recent chats](#)
- [Gemini Apps limits and upgrades](#)
- [Workspace controls for Gemini access](#)
- [Using Google Workspace with Gemini](#)